

window manager part of the panel. The Ubuntu icon on the extreme left serves as the 'Show Desktop' utility.

Applications

Clicking on the categories in the left column, you get the standard Ubuntu collection. You have the OpenOffice.org suite, Totem, Rhythmbox, the GIMP, and other programs you're used to, from the stock release. Likewise, expanding the *System* section, you have everything you would expect from the Ubuntu. As always, installing new programs is dead easy with Synaptic.

You won't get codecs for proprietary formats out-of-the-box, but you will be able to download and install them the first time you try to play a file in one of these formats, like mp3, for instance. Similarly, Flash is not available by default, but you can install it either manually or via the Medibuntu repository.

To sum up

Overall, UNR is a solid product. It's Ubuntu, dedicated to the 'low-specs' market with very handy UI enhancements that make it ideal for devices with lesser screen real estate. If you have a netbook and don't particularly care for a sub-optimal Windows XP installation, nor do you wish to dabble with the brand-new Moblin 2.1, then Ubuntu Netbook Remix seems like a good idea. I believe you will like the result. The

combination of open source, lots of good programs, stability, usability, and decent looks is really hard to beat.

Of course, there's a Kubuntu Netbook Remix too for the hard-core KDE4 users. **END** 



Kubuntu Netbook Remix 9.10. Read the review online @ www.linuxforu.com/reviews/kubuntu-netbook-remix-review

By: Sayantan Pal

An avid Twitter user and a social media enthusiast, the author is a passionate blogger and a professional gamer too. He also feels compelled to be opinionated about anything that comes his way, be it Linux distributions, our marketing strategies, table etiquettes or even the fabled Ramsay movies!

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Vipul Mehra, General Manager, vipulm@eigroup.in
Tel: +91 11 4279 5000 / 5030 M: +91 99102 04131

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